

Word family: **task / tasks / tasked / tasking / multitask / multitasking**

Base word: task

Part of speech: mainly **noun**, also **verb**

Related forms:

task (n.) — 任務；工作；工作項目

task (v.) — 指派任務；要求某人完成某事

tasked (participle) — 被指派去做.....

tasking (n./adj., technical/formal) — 任務分配；任務指派

multitask (v.) — 同時處理多項事情

multitasking (n.) — 多工處理；同時處理多項工作

Useful expressions / extensions:

complete a task

carry out a task

perform a task

finish a task

difficult task

simple task

routine task

specific task

task at hand

take someone to task

task someone with doing something

be tasked with

task force

multitask

multitasking

Meaning in this passage

> I broke large **tasks** into smaller steps...

and:

> I also began waking up earlier and doing the hardest **tasks** first...

Here, **task** means:

a specific piece of work that needs to be completed — 任務；工作項目

The speaker took large pieces of work and divided them into manageable steps.

****中文翻譯：****

我把大型****工作 / 任務****拆成較小的步驟。

So here:

****task = 一項需要完成、有明確目的的工作****

1. ****task (任務 ; 工作) — 任務 ; 工作項目****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I broke large ****tasks**** into smaller steps.

我把大型****任務****拆成較小的步驟。

Practice 2

> I always do the hardest ****task**** first.

我總是先做最困難的****任務****。

Practice 3

> This ****task**** should take about an hour.

這項****工作****應該大約需要一小時。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****task = 一項需要完成、通常有明確目的或結果的工作****

2. ****complete / finish a task — 完成任務****

Practice 1

> I completed the ****task**** before lunch.

我午飯前完成了這項****任務****。

Practice 2

> She stayed late to **finish the task**.

她留到很晚才**完成工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

complete/finish a task = 把指定工作全部做完

3. **carry out a task — 執行任務**

Practice 1

> Each team member had to **carry out a different task**.

每名組員都要**執行不同任務**。

Practice 2

> The machine can **carry out repetitive tasks**.

這部機器可以**執行重複性工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

carry out a task = 按要求執行並完成某項工作

4. **perform a task — 執行工作；完成任務**

Practice 1

> The software can **perform several tasks automatically**.

這套軟件可以自動**執行幾項工作**。

Practice 2

> Employees are trained to **perform the task safely**.

員工接受培訓，以安全地**執行這項任務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****perform a task = 執行某項指定工作或功能****

5. ****difficult / challenging task — 困難任務****

Practice 1

> Writing the report was a ****difficult task****.

寫報告是一項****困難任務****。

Practice 2

> Managing several deadlines at once can be a ****challenging task****.

同時管理多個截止日期可以是一項****具挑戰性的工作****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****difficult task = 需要較多努力、能力或時間才能完成的工作****

6. ****simple / easy task — 簡單任務****

Practice 1

> This is a relatively ****simple task****.

這是一項相對****簡單的任務****。

Practice 2

> Even an ****easy task**** can become stressful if you leave it too late.

即使是****簡單工作****，拖得太遲也可能令人有壓力。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****simple/easy task = 不需要太多時間、技巧或努力的工作****

7. ****routine task — 例行工作****

Practice 1

> Checking emails is a **routine task** for many workers.

查看電郵是很多人的**例行工作**。

Practice 2

> The system automates several **routine tasks**.

系統會自動處理幾項**日常例行工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

routine task = 經常重複、按固定方式完成的工作

8. **specific task — 特定任務**

Practice 1

> Each tool is designed for a **specific task**.

每件工具都是為某項**特定任務**而設。

Practice 2

> I was given a **specific task** to complete.

我獲指派完成一項**特定工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

specific task = 目的、內容或要求已清楚界定的工作

9. **the task at hand — 眼前的任務；當前工作**

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Let's focus on **the task at hand**.

我們集中處理**眼前的工作**吧。

Practice 2

> She ignored distractions and returned to **the task at hand**.

她沒有理會干擾，重新專注於**當前任務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

the task at hand = 現在最需要處理的工作

10. **task (艱巨工作；重任) — 艱巨任務**

A nuance where **task** emphasizes difficulty or responsibility.

Practice 1

> Rebuilding trust was no easy **task**.

重建信任絕非一項容易的**任務**。

Practice 2

> Leading the team through the crisis was a huge **task**.

帶領團隊渡過危機是一項**艱巨重任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

task = 需要大量努力或責任才能完成的工作

11. **task someone with doing something — 指派某人做某事**

A major verb construction.

Practice 1

> The manager **tasked me with preparing the report**.

經理**指派我準備報告**。

Practice 2

> She was **tasked with organising the event**.

她被**指派負責籌備活動**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****task someone with doing X = 正式指派某人負責完成 X****

12. ****be tasked with — 被指派負責.....****

Practice 1

> I was ****tasked with checking the final slides****.

我被****指派負責檢查最後的投影片****。

Practice 2

> The team was ****tasked with finding a solution****.

團隊被****指派負責尋找解決方法****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be tasked with X = 被正式安排負責 X****

13. ****task someone to do something — 指派某人做某事****

Less common than ****task someone with doing something****, but established.

Practice 1

> The committee ****tasked him to review the report****.

委員會****指派他審閱報告****。

Practice 2

> She was ****tasked to investigate the issue****.

她被****指派調查這個問題****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****task someone to do X = 正式要求某人負責完成 X****

14. ****take someone to task — 責備；斥責某人****

A very important idiom.

Practice 1

> The teacher **took him to task** for arriving late.

老師因他遲到而**責備他**。

Practice 2

> She **took the company to task** over its poor service.

她因服務欠佳而**嚴厲批評公司**。

MCQ-ready definition:

take someone to task = 因某人的行為或錯誤而嚴厲批評或責備對方

15. **task force** — 專責小組；特遣隊

A lexicalized compound.

Practice 1

> The company formed a **task force** to deal with the problem.

公司成立了一個**專責小組**處理問題。

Practice 2

> A special **task force** was created to investigate the issue.

當局成立了特別**專責小組**調查事件。

MCQ-ready definition:

task force = 為處理某個特定問題或任務而成立的臨時專門小組

16. **task force (military)** — 特遣部隊

Practice 1

> A naval **task force** was sent to the region.

一支海軍**特遣部隊**被派往該區。

Practice 2

> The **task force** included several ships.

這支**特遣部隊**包括數艘軍艦。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****task force = 為特定軍事任務臨時編成的部隊****

17. **multitask — 同時處理多項事情**

Practice 1

> I used to think I could **multitask** effectively.

我以前以為自己可以有效地**同時處理多項事情**。

Practice 2

> It's hard to **multitask** when you're tired.

疲累時很難**一心多用**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****multitask = 同一時間嘗試處理多項工作或活動****

18. **multitasking — 多工處理；一心多用**

Practice 1

> Too much **multitasking** can reduce concentration.

過度**一心多用**可能降低專注力。

Practice 2

> ****Multitasking**** is common in busy workplaces.

在繁忙工作環境中，**多工處理**很常見。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****multitasking = 同時處理兩項或以上工作的行為****

19. ****task (computing : 程序 / 處理工作) — 工作程序 ; 任務****

A common technical sense.

Practice 1

> The computer is running several ****tasks**** in the background.

電腦正在背景執行數個****工作程序****。

Practice 2

> This ****task**** is using a lot of memory.

這個****程序 / 任務****正在使用大量記憶體。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****task = 電腦系統正在執行的一項工作或程序活動****

20. ****task manager — 工作管理員 ; 任務管理工具****

Practice 1

> Open the ****Task Manager**** to see which programs are running.

打開****工作管理員****查看哪些程式正在運行。

Practice 2

> I used a ****task manager**** to organise my daily work.

我用****任務管理工具****整理每天的工作。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****task manager = 用來查看、管理電腦程序，或整理待辦工作與任務的工具****

Note that this compound has two common contexts:

* computing system utility
* productivity/to-do software

21. **task-based** — 以任務為本的

A useful compound adjective.

Practice 1

> The course uses **task-based learning**.

這個課程採用**任務為本學習**。

Practice 2

> The assessment is **task-based**.

評估是**以任務為基礎的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

task-based = 以完成具體任務作為主要活動或組織方式的

22. **task-based learning** — 任務為本學習

A common language-teaching term.

Practice 1

> **Task-based learning** encourages students to use language for real purposes.

任務為本學習鼓勵學生為真實目的使用語言。

Practice 2

> The lesson includes several **task-based activities**.

課堂包括幾項**任務式活動**。

MCQ-ready definition:

task-based learning = 透過完成有實際目的的任務來學習語言或技能的方法

Important distinction 1: **task vs assignment**

Very relevant to your passage.

task

any specific piece of work.

assignment

work formally given by a teacher, manager, etc.

> write the introduction

> = a **task**

> complete a university essay assigned by your lecturer

> = an **assignment**

An assignment can contain many tasks.

Important distinction 2: **task vs job**

task

one particular piece of work.

job

broader:

* employment,

* position,

* piece of work.

> My job is teaching.

> 我的職業是教學。

> My first task today is answering emails.

> 我今天第一項任務是回覆電郵。

Important distinction 3: **task vs duty**

****task****

specific piece of work.

****duty****

responsibility you are expected or obliged to perform.

> task = 要完成甚麼

> duty = 你有甚麼責任

A duty may involve many individual tasks.

Important distinction 4: ****task vs chore****

****chore****

routine, often boring household or everyday work.

****task****

neutral.

> washing dishes = household chore

> 洗碗 = 家務

> analysing data = task

> 分析數據 = 任務

****Task**** does not automatically imply boredom.

Important distinction 5: ****task vs activity****

****activity****

anything someone does.

****task****

usually has a goal and expected completion.

> chatting with friends = activity

> 和朋友聊天 = 活動

> finish a report = task

> 完成報告 = 任務

Important distinction 6: **task vs project**

task

usually smaller and more specific.

project

often larger and made up of multiple tasks.

Your passage directly demonstrates this planning logic:

> large tasks → smaller steps

Similarly:

> project → multiple tasks → smaller steps

Important distinction 7: **task vs responsibility**

responsibility

what you are accountable for.

task

what you actually have to do.

> responsibility: manage the presentation

> 責任：管理整個簡報

> tasks: edit slides, check speakers, upload file

> 任務：修改投影片、確認發言者、上傳檔案

Important distinction 8: **task someone with vs assign**

They are very close.

> task Kevin with checking the file

> 指派 Kevin 檢查檔案

> assign Kevin the job of checking the file

> 把檢查檔案的工作分配給 Kevin

Task with sounds slightly more formal and responsibility-focused.

Important distinction 9: **be tasked with + noun / -ing**

Natural:

> tasked with the investigation

> 負責調查

> tasked with investigating

> 被指派調查

Do not normally say:

> **tasked with to investigate** ❌

Important distinction 10: **take someone to task**

This does **not** mean:

> give someone a task

It means:

criticise them strongly

So:

> task someone with X

> = 指派工作

but:

> take someone to task

> = 責備某人

Major idiom trap.

Important distinction 11: **task force** is lexicalized

It does not simply mean “a force that has a task.”

It normally refers to:

a specially formed group for one problem or mission

The group may be civilian, organizational, law-enforcement, or military.

Important distinction 12: **multitask** vs **do several tasks**

multitask

do/process several things at approximately the same time.

do several tasks

may simply mean complete them one after another.

That timing difference matters.

Important distinction 13: **task** in computing

A computer **task** is a unit of work/process execution.

It does not necessarily correspond to a human-visible program.

So:

> application/program

> and

> task/process

can overlap, but are not always identical.

Family-extension note

Task has a coherent core:

a defined piece of work to be done

From that, several useful branches develop:

1. **ordinary work**

- * complete a task
- * difficult task
- * routine task

2. **current priority**

- * task at hand

3. **formal assignment**

- * task someone with
- * be tasked with

4. **criticism idiom**

- * take someone to task

5. **special-purpose group**

- * task force

6. **simultaneous work**

- * multitask
- * multitasking

7. **computing**

- * computer task
- * Task Manager

8. **education**

* task-based learning

For your passage, the exact meaning is:

task = a specific piece of work the speaker needed to complete

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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task	任務；工作項目	defined work	
complete a task	完成任務	completion	
carry out a task	執行任務	perform	
perform a task	執行工作	function	
difficult task	困難任務	challenging work	
routine task	例行工作	repeated work	
specific task	特定任務	clearly defined	
task at hand	當前任務	immediate focus	
task (heavy responsibility)	重任	demanding work	
task someone with X	指派某人負責 X	formal assignment	
be tasked with X	被指派負責 X	formal responsibility	
take someone to task	責備某人	criticism	
task force	專責小組	special group	
task force (military)	特遣部隊	special military unit	
multitask	同時處理多項事情	simultaneous work	
multitasking	多工處理；一心多用	simultaneous processing	
task (computing)	工作程序；任務	computer work unit	
task manager	工作管理員 / 任務管理工具	manage tasks	
task-based	以任務為本的	structured around tasks	
task-based learning	任務為本學習	learning through tasks	

For your original passage

> I bought a simple planner, started writing down deadlines, broke large **tasks** into smaller steps...

and:

> I also began waking up earlier and doing the hardest **tasks** first...

Here:

tasks = 一項項需要完成的具體工作，例如寫作業、準備簡報、溫習或處理其他責任

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我把大型**工作 / 任務**拆成較小的步驟。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **task** = 一項具體工作

> **assignment** = 被正式分配的作業 / 任務

> **project** = 通常較大型、由多項 task 組成

> **responsibility** = 你需要負責的範圍

In this passage, **task** is especially useful because the speaker is learning to turn **large pieces of work into smaller, manageable units**.